

Come Down, O Love Divine

- 1 Come down, O Love divine!
Seek thou this soul of mine
and visit it with thine own ardor glowing.
O Comforter, draw near,
within my heart appear,
and kindle it, thy holy flame bestowing.
- 2 O let it freely burn,
till earthly passions turn
to dust and ashes in its heat consuming;
and let thy glorious
light shine ever on my sight,
and clothe me round, the while my path illumining.
- 3 Let holy charity
mine outward vesture be,
and lowliness become mine inner clothing;
true lowliness of heart,
which takes the humbler part,
and o'er its own shortcomings weeps with loathing.
- 4 And so the yearning strong,
with which the soul will long,
shall far out pass the pow'r of human telling;
for none can guess its grace,
till he become the place
wherein the Holy Spirit makes his dwelling.

Words: Bianco de Siena, 15th cent.; tr. Richard Frederick Littledale, 1867; alt.

Music: Ralph Vaughan Williams, 1906

Tune: DOWN AMPNEY · 6.6.11.D · Scripture: 1 Corinthians 6:19

Public domain.